CHAPTER 1

The Old Playbook Is Dead

Pragmatic Remix: All 37 Boxes (Reframed) | Funnel Stage: Foundational

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The agentic era didn't accelerate the old B2B playbook — it ended it. Product lifecycles now run in continuous deployment, not quarterly releases. Buyers consume content through AI intermediaries, not your website. GEO has replaced SEO. The funnel is no longer a funnel. This chapter establishes the foundational thesis for the entire curriculum.

The Story of Sarah

Sometime in late 2024, a product marketer we know—let's call her Sarah—noticed something strange in her pipeline data. Sarah ran product marketing for a mid-market analytics platform, the kind of company that sells to data teams at Fortune 2000 firms. She was good at her job. She'd built the positioning, trained the sales team, published the battlecards, ran the launches. Her funnel metrics had been steady for two years.

And then, over the course of about six weeks, three things happened simultaneously: First, her website traffic went up—but her form fills went down. Second, her sales team started reporting that prospects were showing up to discovery calls already knowing things they shouldn't have known—competitive pricing, technical limitations, integration details. Third, two enterprise deals closed in under three weeks. The typical sales cycle was eleven weeks.

What had actually changed was something far more interesting: her buyers had started using AI agents to do the research, the comparison shopping, and the vendor pre-qualification that used to take human buying committees weeks of meetings, spreadsheets, and hallway conversations to accomplish. Sarah's buyer had hired an intermediary that didn't care about brand affinity, didn't respond to emotional storytelling, and couldn't be schmoozed over a steak dinner.

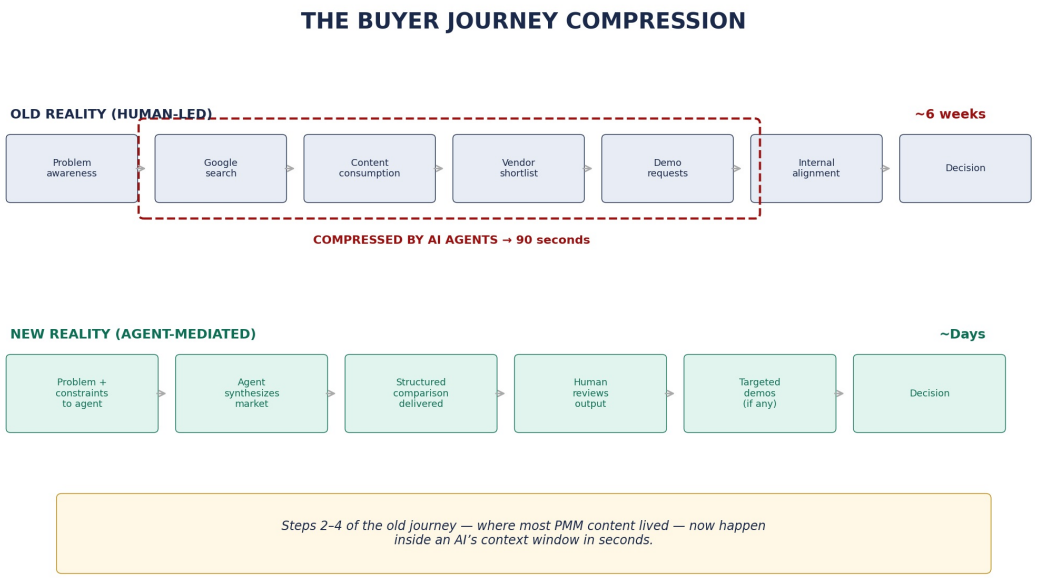

Figure 1: Steps 2–4 of the old journey—where most PMM content lived—now happen inside an AI's context window in seconds.

The Three Eras of Enterprise Data

The history of how companies collect, organize, and activate data is not just a technology story—it's the story of what becomes possible when the architecture changes. We think of this history in three eras:

Era One: The Data Warehouse (Age of Reports). ETL batch jobs. Static deliverables. Quarterly reviews. The Pragmatic Framework was built for this cadence—when data moved slowly, marketing moved slowly, and buyers moved slowly too.

Era Two: The Data Lake (Age of Unification). The CDP era. Customer strategy. Journey mapping. Win/loss analysis. "A DMP knew your audience. A CDP knows your customer."

Era Three: The Data Fabric (Age of Agents). Agentic AI. Federated metadata. Agents that monitor, adjust, and generate. "A DMP knew your audience. A CDP knew your customer. An AMP knows your business." And now the buyer has an agent too.

The Visibility Gap

The visibility gap is the delta between what AI agents can access and process versus what remains invisible to them. Most B2B marketing assets—the elaborate nurture sequences, the gated content, the personalized ABM campaigns—exist in the invisible zone.

Agents can't fill out forms. They don't click through email sequences. They don't attend webinars. The content that many marketing organizations spent years perfecting is becoming structurally inaccessible to the new buyer journey.

THE VISIBILITY GAP

What AI agents surface vs. what most PMM teams produce

WHAT AGENTS CAN PROCESS	WHAT AGENTS SKIP
✓ Structured comparison data (schema.org)	✗ Narrative product pages
✓ Third-party review rankings (G2, Capterra)	✗ Video testimonials & demos
✓ Technical documentation & APIs	✗ Gated PDF case studies & ebooks
✓ Machine-readable pricing structures	✗ JavaScript-rendered content
✓ News with verifiable citations	✗ Email nurture sequences

The Visibility Gap is not a technology problem — it is a prioritization problem.

Figure 2: The Visibility Gap is not a technology problem—it is a prioritization problem.

From SEO to GEO

Search engine optimization assumed humans would search, scan, and click. Generative engine optimization assumes AI will ingest, synthesize, and cite. The mechanics are fundamentally different.

SEO optimized for ranking. GEO optimizes for citation. SEO cared about keywords and backlinks. GEO cares about structured data, factual accuracy, and authoritative sourcing. SEO competed for the first page. GEO competes for inclusion in the training data and retrieval corpus.

FROM SEO TO GEO

Generative Engine Optimization

	SEO	→ GEO
Optimize for	Ranking on a list	**Citation in a synthesis**
Compete on	Keywords	**Entity authority**
Build	Backlinks	**Structured proof points**
What matters	Title tag	**Schema markup**
Volume effect	More content helps	**Better structure helps**
Buyer sees	Blue links	**Synthesized answer**

Figure 3: SEO optimizes for ranking on a list. GEO optimizes for citation in a synthesized answer.

> **The Audit — Do This Week**
>
> Open Claude, ChatGPT, or Perplexity, and ask it to evaluate vendors in your product category. See if your company appears. Read what it says about you. That sixty-second exercise will tell you more about your GEO readiness than any consultant's report.

The Pragmatic Framework Meets the Machine

If you've been through Pragmatic Institute training, you know the Framework. Thirty-seven boxes arranged in seven categories. What happens to each of those thirty-seven boxes when AI agents become part of the team? The exercise produced three natural clusters:

Cluster One: Automated. Market sizing, derivative content, event logistics, sales tools production. Agents can perform the majority of this work today. If your value is producing artifacts—the battlecard, the one-pager, the launch email—the automation wave is not your friend.

Cluster Two: Augmented. Positioning, win/loss analysis, buyer personas, pricing strategy. The human

remains essential but the human-agent team is so much better that operating without agents becomes a competitive disadvantage.

Cluster Three: Elevated. Stakeholder management, customer empathy, thought leadership. These activities become more important, more central, and more career-defining precisely because they are the ones that machines can't do.

> *"The 10x PMM is not the one with the best prompt library. It is the one who has fundamentally rewired how they think about markets, products, and customers.*

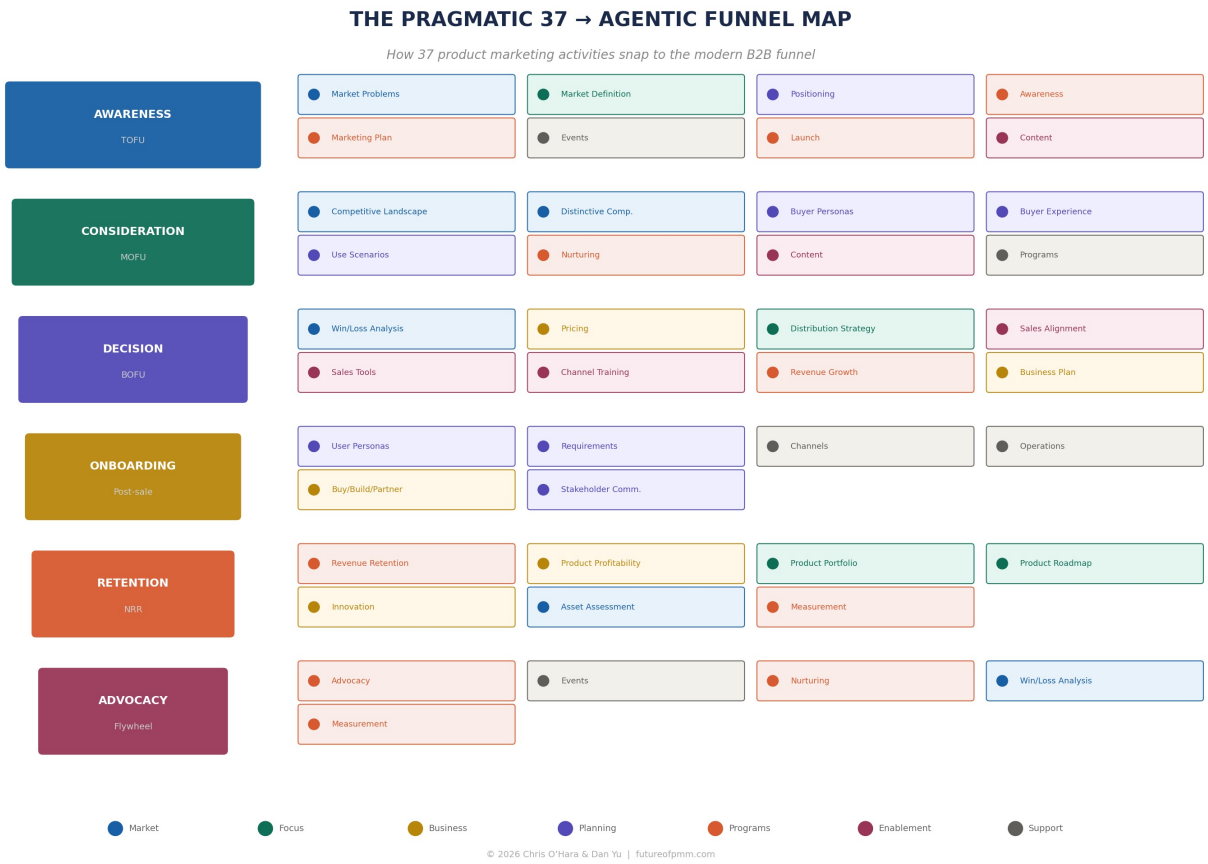

Figure 4: All 37 Pragmatic activities mapped to the six-stage agentic funnel.

A PMM who automates twenty hours a week of Cluster One work and redirects that time into deeper competitive analysis, more thoughtful positioning, and genuine thought leadership will outperform one still manually updating battlecards. Not by twenty percent. By a factor that justifies the title of this curriculum.

That is what "10x yourself" means. Not working ten times harder or faster. Operating at a fundamentally different level of strategic impact because you've offloaded the mechanical work to machines built for it, and you're finally free to do the work that only a human can do.

CMO PERSPECTIVE

The conversation about AI inside marketing departments right now is almost entirely wrong. It's focused on efficiency—how do we produce the same outputs with fewer people. That's a CFO question, not a CMO question.

The CMO question—the one we wrote this curriculum to answer—is how do we produce fundamentally different outputs? How do we shift from quarterly competitive reviews to continuous intelligence? How do we move from static messaging frameworks to dynamic positioning that adapts to what agents are surfacing in real time?

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- The agentic shift is a structural transformation of the PMM discipline, not just a toolkit upgrade.
- Buyer behavior has already changed—AI agents are compressing research cycles from weeks to hours, and most PMM content is invisible to them.
- The "10x" thesis isn't about speed. It's about the widening output gap between PMMs who internalize the shift and those who don't.
- The Pragmatic Framework's 37 activities cluster into three tiers: automatable, augmentable, and irreducibly human.
- The PMM who frees Cluster One hours to invest in Cluster Three is operating at a different level.